

ONCE UPON A TIME, and it was in 1926 when the Giants were in New York, a fellow named Babe Ruth was packing in fans for the rival Yankees and Giant management was desperate for a good drawing card.

Because of the large Jewish population of the city, the Giants searched high and low for a talented Jew who might build a large local following, even if not able to smite as many home runs as the Bambino.

Lo and behold, they latched ahold of an infielder in the minors, Andy Cohen, and brought him up in mid-season. In those days, before public address systems, a man with a megaphone made announcements from the home plate area.

Anxious to get about establishing Cohen, the management promptly sent him in the day he reported, to pinch hit for a popular Irish infielder, Joseph Doyle.

"And now, subbing for Joseph Doyle and appearing at the Polo Grounds for the first time ... Cohen! Andy Cohen!" yelled the man with the megaphone.

A bulky, redfaced Irishman, of the type who might take a drink, promptly stood up in the stands behind home plate and bellowed back, even louder:

"And now ... leaving the Polo Grounds for the last time is me ... O'Grady! Michael O'Grady!"

Cohen hit 14 home runs and .281 in three major league seasons and did not take much interest away from Ruth. Years later, he was a popular figure here as Denver manager during the post-war heyday of the Three-I League.